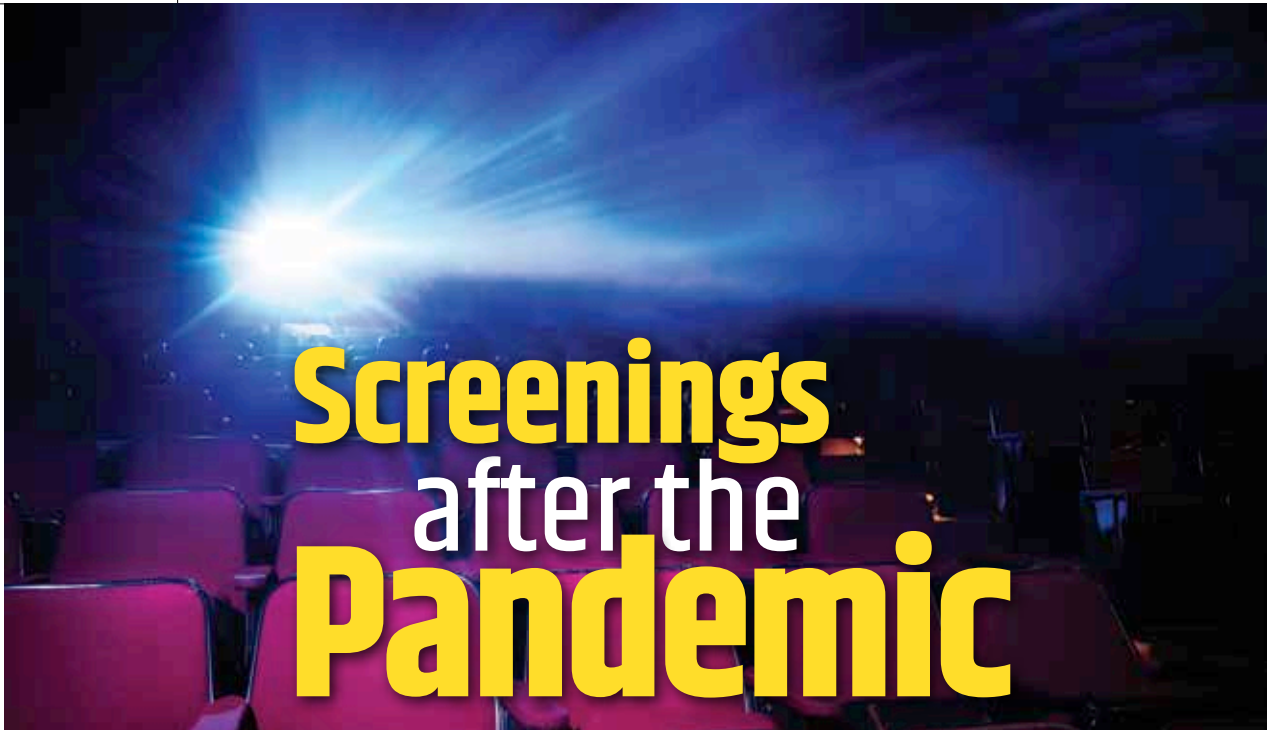


**INOX statement**

The strongly worded message for honouring content window practices for digital releases, from INOX. <https://dgit.in/aug20-21>

**Producers guild statement**

The statement by filmmakers outlining the various financial pressures faced by the industry. <https://dgit.in/aug20-22>



Screenings after the Pandemic

A lucrative industry in crisis is lashing out and trying to reconcile with the new order of things, struggling to make sense out of an unprecedented situation.

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very year, between 1,500 to 2,000 movies are produced across India in 20 languages, which is

an industry that employs lakhs of people. The outbreak has thrown the entire machinery out of whack, with box offices being closed, release dates being pushed back, and shooting schedules being seriously disrupted. The TV industry seems to be going ahead somewhat, with some ridiculous scenes of romance through face shields. Some films are still being shot in locations around the world where the virus is contained. Movie theatres continue to be closed indefinitely at this point in time. In short there have been serious disruptions to the movie watching habits, and this may have long term

implications. In a survey conducted by Pinkvilla, 70 percent of respondents planned to move to an OTT platform, 80 percent said they would not be comfortable going to a movie theatre, and 76 percent of the respondents still preferred the good old TV as the primary source of entertainment. This is an unprecedented crisis for the industry, with both the producers and the exhibitors sustaining hundreds of crores of losses every single day.

THE SHIFT TO OTT

One of the things that started happening almost immediately was that the movies that were already scheduled for release were instead released on OTT platforms. Ajay Devgan's *Bhuj: The Pride of India*, Sushant Singh Rajput's *Dil Bechara*, Abhishek Bachchan's *The Big Bull*, and Alia Bhatt's *Sadak 2* are all heading to Disney Hotstar. Vidya Balan's *Shakuntala*

Devi, and Amitabh Bachchan starrer *Gulabo Sitabo* were bagged by Amazon Prime. Jhanvi Kapoor's *Gunkan Saxena* will be releasing on Netflix. At this point filmmakers are met with a hard choice of making no money at all and getting some from a digital release. This move by film makers of going directly to OTT platforms has not gone down well with the theatre owners, obviously. One of the first films to make the jump was the Irrfan Khan and Kareena Kapoor Khan starrer *Angeeri Medium*, which was showing in theatres when the pandemic hit. It released quickly on Disney Hotstar, but obviously did not manage to rake in as much as it would have during a regular theatrical run.

What followed the spate of announcements of partnerships between filmmakers and OTT platforms was a bunch of statements from the exhibitors including INOX, PVR and Carnival asking the filmmakers maintain the time honoured and decades long partnership for the windows reserved for theatrical screenings before moving to other platforms. These statements warned of retaliatory action, where the future movies from the same makers would